



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*śrutvāpi śuddhacaitanyamātmānamatisundaram |
upasthe+atyantasamsakto mālinyamadhigacchati | 3 | 4 |*

— Aṣṭāvakragītā, Prakaraṇa 3 (Chapter 3), Verse 4

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Even after hearing about the pure, beautiful nature of your true Self – that radiant consciousness which is the very essence of existence – you can still become tainted and impure if you remain excessively attached to the pleasures of the body, specifically focusing on the seat of sexual desire. This verse from the Aṣṭāvakragītā highlights a profound paradox: intellectual understanding is not enough for liberation. You might intellectually grasp the concept of your inherent purity, your divine nature, but if your actions and thoughts are constantly drawn towards sensory gratification, particularly sexual indulgence, that understanding remains just a concept, failing to permeate your being.

The scripture isn't condemning pleasure itself, but rather the *excessive* attachment to it. It's about balance. Think of a beautiful song; enjoying it is natural, but becoming obsessed with it to the point of neglecting all other aspects of your life leads to imbalance. Similarly, the intense focus on physical gratification, especially in the realm of sexuality, can cloud your perception of the true Self. It creates a kind of "dirt" or "impurity" (mālinyam) that obscures the inherent radiance of your consciousness.

In modern life, where sexual imagery and gratification are readily available and often promoted, this verse offers a crucial reminder. You are bombarded with messages that equate happiness with physical pleasure, constantly tempting you to indulge in sensory experiences. The Aṣṭāvakragītā encourages you to be mindful of these influences and to cultivate a sense of detachment. It invites you to explore your inner landscape beyond the fleeting sensations of the body, to discover the lasting joy and peace that reside within your true Self. It is about recognizing that your happiness and fulfillment cannot solely depend on external stimuli, but rather on the realization of your own inherent divinity. This is not about repression, but about conscious awareness and choosing to identify with something more enduring than transient pleasure.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify any areas in your life where you are excessively attached to sensory gratification, and how might this be obscuring your connection to your true Self?